

Jake Howden

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Cardiff, South Wales

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Cloud-native .NET engineer with 8+ years designing event-driven platforms on AWS and Azure. I have tackled a range of problems, worked with cross-functional teams, and engineered features that improve customer experience and revenue metrics.

Education

University of South Wales

BSc (Hons) Computer Games Development

First-Class Honours

09/2015–06/2018

Technical Skills

Programming

C#, .NET, .NET Core, ASP.NET Core, CosmosDB, DynamoDB, PostgreSQL, TDD, xUnit, Kafka, SQS/SNS, Service Bus, Event Hubs

Architecture

Cloud, Microservices, Event Driven, Domain-Driven Design, CQRS, HTTP, Messaging, Architecture Decision Records

DevOps

Terraform, Helm Charts, Serverless, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, Infrastructure as Code, ArgoCD

Cloud

AWS, Azure, Serverless, Kubernetes (AKS, EKS), Docker, AWS Lambda, Azure Functions, Cloudflare

Leadership

Technical Leadership, Mentoring, Stakeholder Management, Engineering Standards, Migration Planning

Experience

Confused.com (RVU)

Cardiff, United Kingdom

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

02/2026–Present

- As technical lead of 3 engineers, owned the architecture of a new client-facing portal replacing manual account management: AKS behind Cloudflare and App Gateway WAF, with event-driven integration on Event Hubs.
- Averted a second portal build by making the case for folding a legacy internal portal into the new one, aligning four stakeholders one-to-one before the decision; then led the phased migration planning.
- Cut the time to stand up production services from 3 days to 22 minutes by leading the build of a multi-agent AI orchestrator.
- Established a company-wide standard for Architecture Decision Records, with a central site now used by 15+ teams.
- Consolidated divergent CI pipelines into shared GitHub Actions templates now used by 4 teams.
- Drove Claude Code adoption outside engineering, onboarding 18 staff in 3 sessions with a setup guide other guilds reused.

Just Eat Takeaway

Bristol, United Kingdom

SOFTWARE ENGINEER

09/2024–02/2026

- Engineered and architected an event-driven platform generating €243 million in annual revenue.
- Migrated legacy services from EC2 to Kubernetes (EKS), reducing infrastructure spend by 30%.
- Standardised our messaging framework to eliminate duplicated code and reduce complexity across microservices.
- Integrated E2E test suites into CI/CD pipelines, strengthening release gates and improving service reliability.
- Championed multiple features which improved agent efficiency and customer satisfaction.
- Mentored senior developers transitioning to .NET, offering guidance in engineering and testing best practices.

Ensono

Remote, United Kingdom

SOFTWARE CONSULTANT

04/2022–04/2024

- Successfully delivered a marketing system overhaul for Next PLC, migrating on-prem monoliths to cloud microservices in a £5 million contract.
- Designed and implemented CI/CD pipelines to deploy services to Azure Kubernetes Service.
- Co-led a £1.2 million initiative rebuilding admissions and finance communications for a London university with Azure Functions and Azure Service Bus.
- Applied TDD, automated regression suites, and infrastructure-as-code to sustain high deployment confidence.
- Facilitated stakeholder workshops and roadmap reviews that aligned engineering deliverables with business milestones.

Tytonical

Remote, United Kingdom

BACKEND DEVELOPER

06/2020–04/2022

- Owned end-to-end delivery of back-end web APIs and full-stack applications for fintech and media clients.
- Prioritised scalability and high availability when designing AWS ECS deployments, ensuring cost-efficient operations.
- Brokered partner integrations by defining APIs, SLAs, and support processes that kept joint launches on schedule.
- Mentored interns through structured workshops and pair-programming, progressing them to production-ready contributors.

Newpark Solutions

Bristol, United Kingdom

APP MANAGER

01/2019–06/2020

- Directed a full redesign of the parking payment app, coordinating product, design, and engineering across release cycles.
- Led customer support and QA teams, instituting feedback loops that tightened defect triage and response times.
- Maintained and extended backend web services to onboard new municipal clients and payment features.
- Raised the app store rating from 1.5–2 to 4+, improving brand perception and retention.

Newpark Solutions

Bristol, United Kingdom

SOFTWARE ENGINEER

06/2018–01/2019

- Integrated a new payment service provider for in-app payments, improving checkout reliability and compliance.
- Built automated payment services that delivered a frictionless parking experience for customers.